

WORKS, HOPE, FAITH & PATIENCE

TEXT: **Hebrews 6:9-15** *"But, beloved, we are persuaded better things of you, and things that accompany salvation, though we thus speak. ¹⁰For God is not unrighteous to forget your work and labour of love, which ye have shewed toward his name, in that ye have ministered to the saints, and do minister. ¹¹And we desire that every one of you do shew the same diligence to the full assurance of hope unto the end: ¹²That ye be not slothful, but followers of them who through faith and patience inherit the promises. ¹³For when God made promise to Abraham, because he could swear by no greater, he swore by himself, ¹⁴Saying, Surely blessing I will bless thee, and multiplying I will multiply thee. ¹⁵And so, after he had patiently endured, he obtained the promise."*

II. HOPE!

Hebrews 6:11 *"And we desire that every one of you do shew the same diligence to the full assurance of hope unto the end: - (18)That by two immutable things, in which it was impossible for God to lie, we might have a strong consolation, who have fled for refuge to lay hold upon the hope set before us: - (19)Which hope we have as an anchor of the soul, both sure and stedfast, and which entereth into that within the veil;"*

As I preach over the next couple of weeks I will use the words **"HOPE"** and **"CONFIDENCE"** interchangeably, their meanings are exactly the same.

The word **"HOPE"** comes from the Greek word Elpis, and means **"CONFIDENCE"**. There are four areas of **"HOPE"** I want to talk about:

- First, **"CONFIDENCE"** that the Blood of Jesus is enough to cover all my sin's, past, present and future.
- Second, **"HOPE"** that is capable of anchoring my soul (Mind, will, and emotion.) in the midst of the storms of life!
- Third, **"CONFIDENCE"** in His ability and willingness to meet all my needs!
- Fourth, **"HOPE"** in His eminent return!

A. **"CONFIDENCE"** that the Blood of Jesus is enough to cover all my sin's, past, present and future. Mankind has been faced with the problem of sin since Adam and the garden. The thing that makes this sin problem so serious is that it not only breaks communion between God and man, but also breaks relationship! To be separated from God, is to be eternally lost! To be lost, is to be without **"HOPE"**! To be without **"HOPE"**, is to become miserable and self destructive! **1 Cor. 15:19** *"If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable."*

A lack of **"HOPE"** is the reason for most of this worlds problems. When a person loses **"HOPE"** they lose their ability to reason or to care! Sin will drive you to a point of

“HOPELESSNESS”, thus causing you to do things you never thought you would do. As this begins to happen the old account is steadily growing; the more you sin, the less you care, the more “HOPELESS” you feel! This is what I would call a vicious cycle that drives you lower and lower until you despair of life itself.

What can raise you from this pit of despair and cause you to begin to “HOPE” again? The old song say’s “What can wash away my sin? Nothing but the Blood of Jesus! What can make me whole again? Nothing but the Blood of Jesus!”... **Zech. 13:1** “*In that day there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness.*” **Romans 5:8-11** “*But God demonstrates his own love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us. Since we have now been justified by his blood, how much more shall we be saved from God's wrath through him! For if, when we were God's enemies, we were reconciled to him through the death of his Son, how much more, having been reconciled, shall we be saved through his life! Not only is this so, but we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received reconciliation.*” **1 Peter 1:18-19** “*For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life handed down to you from your forefathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or defect.*”

One of the greatest deterrents to the restoration of our “HOPE” through the Blood of Jesus is our inability to forgive ourselves! **Romans 8:1-2** “*There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit. For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death.*” The law of sin and death is a law of “HOPELESSNESS”!

There are two reasons the enemy puts so much effort into tearing down our “CONFIDENCE” with regard to the forgiveness we have received through the Blood of Jesus:

- He knows God has forgiven us, and no accusation he brings before God with regard to our past life will work! **Ephes. 2:12-16** “*Remember that at that time you were separate from Christ, excluded from citizenship in Israel and foreigners to the covenants of the promise, without hope and without God in the world. But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far away have been brought near through the blood of Christ. For he himself is our peace, who has made the two one and has destroyed the barrier, the dividing wall of hostility, by abolishing in his flesh the law with its commandments and regulations. His purpose was to create in himself one new man out of the two, thus making peace, and in this one body to reconcile both of them to God through the cross, by which he put to death their hostility.*”

- He knows that if he can destroy “HOPE” and “CONFIDENCE” in our own standing and relationship with God, we will be no threat to him! **Hebrews 10:35** “***So do not throw away your confidence; it will be richly rewarded***”

I grew up under the assumption that if you committed one sin you were a backslider and on your way to hell! I have since discovered that this theology was a trick of the enemy to badger and destroy our “CONFIDENCE”, thus rendering us ineffective in the work of the Lord! **1 John 2:1** “***My little children, these things write I unto you, that ye sin not. And if any man sin, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous:***” **1 John 1:7** “***But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship one with another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanseth us from all sin.***”

Here is a life changing truth: I am as clean and righteous as the Blood of Jesus can make me, and am entitled to all the benefits and blessings of a child of God!!!

B. “HOPE” that is capable of anchoring my soul in the midst of the **STORMS** of life!

Today there are two things I want us to look at; **1) Our Souls** **2) Storms and Anchors.**

1) OUR SOULS: Just as God is a triune being, Father, Son and Holy Spirit, man is made of three parts as well, body, **SOUL** and spirit. Your body is the tent you live in. It is the temporary part of man.

Does it seem strange to you that we spend more time, effort and resources on the one part of us that is temporary?

Your spirit is the part of you that is capable of knowing God. This is the part of you that got saved at conversion. The spirit is eternal and will live on in eternity somewhere! You have the right to choose, smoking or non smoking!

Your **SOUL** is your mind, will and emotions - Think about where the governmental seat of those three entities is located - It's all in your head! I turned 42 this past week, I received several cards one of which said, “**Another year older? Remember, age is mostly in your head... That's where you'll find the gray hair, the loss of memory, the false teeth, the loss of memory, the hearing aid, the loss of memory, the failing eyesight, the loss of memory, HAPPY BIRTHDAY! PS... Did I mention the loss of memory?**”

When we face trials and temptations it will almost always be in our soulish nature. The battleground is the mind or **SOUL**! This battle is the flesh against the spirit!

2) STORMS: Webster has the following to say about a **STORM**:

A disturbance in the atmosphere in which there is a strong wind usually accompanied by rain, thunder and lightning. To blow violently! Before you were saved you were living on the devil's turf, doing all the things he could possibly convince you to do. Once you got saved the thing that changed was the fact that you intend to live differently, and God has

promised to always be with you!

God never promised to change your culture or environment, only that he would always be there. He never promised a life without **STORMS**! I've got a friend who is a concrete contractor and he makes a threefold guarantee; the concrete will dry, when it does it will get hard, and it will crack! My guarantee to you this morning, whether you are saved or lost is this, you **WILL** have **STORMS**!

Right now, the enemy is drawing up a plan for a **STORM**, or series of **STORMS**, tailor made to bring about your destruction! You are on his turf - he is the god of this world! It may very well appear that he is going to destroy you with his **STORM**! So what is one to do? I **ANCHOR** my **SOUL** with **HOPE**! Where do I get my **HOPE** even in difficult times? The Word Of God! **2 Cor. 10:3-5** *"For though we live in the world, we do not wage war as the world does. ⁴The weapons we fight with are not the weapons of the world. On the contrary, they have divine power to demolish strongholds. ⁵We demolish arguments and every pretension that sets itself up against the knowledge of God, and we take captive every thought to make it obedient to Christ."* KJV *"The weapons of our warfare are not carnal..."*

A strong emotional outburst. To rage! The most effective weapon the enemy has, is his ability to talk to us! If you will allow him to do so he will verbally abuse you!!! He is an accuser of the brethren! (Story of the three pigs!)

The enemy may instigate, agitate, aggravate, humiliate, huff, puff, harass and threaten, but the one thing he can never do without your cooperation is destroy you! He will tell you that you are not good enough - He will tell you that you are never going to amount to a hill of beans - He will tell you that your children are going to be alcoholics and drug addicts - He will tell you that your marriage is going to end in divorce - He will tell you that you are going to go bankrupt - So what are you to do? **ANCHOR** your **SOUL** with **HOPE**! **1 Cor. 10:13** *"No temptation has seized you except what is common to man. And God is faithful; he will not let you be tempted beyond what you can bear. But when you are tempted, he will also provide a way out so that you can stand up under it."*

A strong disturbance or upheaval of a political or social nature. Violence! A sudden strong attack on a fortified place. To attack in a vigorous or angry outburst! To capture or attempt to capture with a sudden strong attack! The enemy loves to use the element of surprise against us! He attacks when we are riding high, not expecting to be attacked. He attacks in areas that come as a complete surprise to us! **Matthew 10:36** *"A man's enemies will be the members of his own household."* Notice what David has to say, about some of the storms he encountered in his life... **Psalms 55:12-14** *"If an enemy were insulting me, I could endure it; if a foe were raising himself against me, I could hide from him. ¹³But it is you, a man like myself, my companion, my close friend, ¹⁴with whom I once enjoyed sweet fellowship as we walked with the throng at the house of God."*

Quite possibly the worst storm we ever encounter are the storms of rejection and betrayal! Rejected by friends - Rejected by relatives - Rejected by an employer - Rejected by our brothers and sisters at church - When we encounter these storms what are we going to do? **ANCHOR** our **SOULS** with **HOPE!** **Psalm 27:10** ***"When my father and my mother forsake me, then the Lord will take me up."***

Deut. 7:9 ***"Know therefore that the Lord thy God, he is God, the faithful God, which keepeth covenant and mercy with them that love him and keep his commandments to a thousand generations;"*** If a generation is 40 years, this scriptures is saying God will keep any covenant he has made with you for 40,000 years!!!

At the dedication of Solomon's temple Solomon say's, **1 Kings 8:56** ***"Blessed be the Lord, that hath given rest unto his people Israel, according to all that he promised: there hath not failed one word of all his good promise, which he promised by the hand of Moses his servant."***

1 Peter 4:19 ***"Wherefore let them that suffer according to the will of God commit the keeping of their souls to him in well doing, as unto a faithful Creator."***

HOPE sees the invisible, feels the intangible, and achieves the impossible! **Job 13:15** ***"Though he slay me, yet will I hope in him; I will surely defend my ways to his face."***

Song: "The anchor holds in spite of the storm."

C. "CONFIDENCE" in His ability and willingness to meet all my needs! **Philip. 4:19** ***"But my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus."***

Paul is writing to the church at Philippi. As you read the book of Philippians Paul seems to indicate that this church is an ideal church. The Philippian church amounted to a few women at the rivers edge, yet they found a way to minister to the man of God in his time of need, as well as support the work of God at home and abroad. This church was established in the midst of bitter persecution. The most trying of times seemed to constantly stalk this ideal church!

In verse 19 Paul is saying, ***"Thank you for your generosity toward me. I have no way to repay you, but my God shall supply all your need according to his riches in glory by Christ Jesus"***.

This guarantee from Paul to the Philippians is much better than a personal guarantee! He is saying ***"I guarantee you that God will supply all your need, he has put Heaven up as collateral"***.

Paul is saying, God has put Heaven up as collateral against my need being supplied! That gives me “**CONFIDENCE**” that everything is going to turn out fine!

Paul couldn't even supply his own need, how could he go out on such a limb to guarantee this Philippian church that God would thoroughly minister to their every need?

1) He knew God had been faithful to Israel throughout their scenic tour of the wilderness! He led them by a cloud in the day, and a pillar of fire at night! He provided manna for them to eat, and water for them to drink! (It mattered little whether it came from a rock, or a tree turned bitter water sweet.) **Deut. 2:7** “*The Lord your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has watched over your journey through this vast desert. These forty years the Lord your God has been with you, and you have not lacked anything.”*

If God will do this for Israel, will he not do it for us? I have complete “**CONFIDENCE**” that he will supply my need!

2) He was aware that God had provided for Elijah during Three and one half years of famine. You see God sent ravens twice a day with bread and meat, and provided the prophet with his own personal stream.

If God will do such a thing for a prophet under the Old Testament economy will he not do that and more for us? I have “**CONFIDENCE**” that God is going to supply my need!

3) Paul knew that God had provided for a widow woman (This is not just a preacher thing) whose husband was dead, and her only son was about to be sold into slavery to pay her indebtedness. Notice her desperate situation: **2 Kings 4:2** “*And Elisha said unto her, What shall I do for thee? tell me, what hast thou in the house? And she said, Thine handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.”*

Notice the instruction given here: **2 Kings 4:3-4** “*Then he said, Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, even empty vessels; borrow not a few. And when thou art come in, thou shalt shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and shalt pour out into all those vessels, and thou shalt set aside that which is full.”*

Notice what God does in response to her obedience: **2 Kings 4:5-7** “*So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons, who brought the vessels to her; and she poured out. And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son, Bring me yet a vessel. And he said unto her, There is not a vessel more. And the oil stayed. Then she came and told the man of God. And he said, Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy children of the rest.”*

If God cares for the plight of a widow woman and her son under the old covenant, don't you

think he will take care of us? I am very **“CONFIDENT”** that he will see us through.

4) Paul knew that God could provide a miracle for an entire city by the hands of four lepers (2 Kings 7). He doesn't need much, just a little faith, and if he can't find that, a little desperation will do just fine!

Samaria was in famine, four lepers said why sit we here till we die? If we return to the city we will die of starvation, if we go to the host of the Syrians they will kill us! They decided to go into the host of the Syrians fully prepared to die. God caused four lepers dragging down a dusty road to sound like an army!

They ate till they could hold no more, then they said, ***“we do not well”!***

If God will go to such great lengths to meet the need of four lepers, what will he do for you? I have complete **“CONFIDENCE”** that he is going to supply our need!

5) Paul knew about the miracle of the loaves and fishes: 5 loaves two fishes fed 5,000 men plus their women and children!

If God can do such a thing with a little boy's lunch, what can he do with what you have? I have all the **“CONFIDENCE”** in the world that God is going to ***supply all our need according to his riches in Glory by Christ Jesus!***

